

Kara Deskin

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Summary

Full-Stack Developer with a backend focus, specializing in React, TypeScript, Python, and Go, with experience building scalable systems using distributed databases, REST APIs, and applied machine learning.

Education

University of Kansas (KU) Lawrence, KS
Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, GPA - 3.2/4.0 May 2025
Relevant Coursework - Software Engineering II, Artificial Intelligence, Data Structures and Algorithms, Compiler Construction, Database Systems, Communication Networks, Computer Architecture
Certification - Machine Learning A-Z, Udemy January 2025

Skills

Web Development - React, TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6+), HTML5, CSS3, Responsive Design, REST APIs, Flask, Streamlit, Tailwind CSS

Programming & Data - Python, Go, SQL (PostgreSQL, MySQL), pandas, NumPy, C, C++, C#

Cloud & Tools - Git, Docker, AWS, Azure, Vercel, VS Code, Bash, Linux, macOS, Google Colab, CI/CD

Projects

Reframe - AI Mental Health Chatbot May 2025 - Present

GitHub - github.com/karadeskin/reframe

- Built an AI chatbot with an interactive Streamlit web interface for journaling and mood tracking
- Integrated sentiment analysis with TextBlob to track mood trends using SQL-based logging
- Designed and deployed a web-accessible application with data processing and visualizations using pandas

Music Recommendation System (PCA + KNN)

September 2024 - Present

GitHub - github.com/karadeskin/Music-Recommendation

- Created a content-based music recommender using Python, pandas, NumPy, SQL, and Spotify feature data
- Applied PCA to reduce dimensionality and KNN for similarity scoring
- Developed a Flask API for song recommendations

Work Experience

Acellus

Kansas City, MO

Full-Stack Developer Apprentice

August 2025 – Present

- Owned backend development for the Acellus Gold Store e-commerce platform using Go, ScyllaDB, and REST APIs, supporting student purchases, admin workflows, and order management
- Architected multi-layer caching and optimized ScyllaDB schemas and partition keys, significantly improving API performance and reducing database load
- Built a production email notification system using Go templates and SMTP for shipment updates, order history, and customer support workflows
- Debugged production issues (race conditions, caching invalidation, distributed database issues) and wrote unit tests to improve reliability and maintainability

KU Wingspan - Center for Learning and Writing Support

Lawrence, KS

Programming, Calculus, and Chemistry Tutor

August 2022 - May 2024

- Tutored over 30 students in Python, Calculus, and Chemistry, improving problem-solving and coding efficiency
- Provided clear, step-by-step technical support and troubleshooting assistance to students
- Developed personalized learning plans, resulting in a 20% improvement in students' test scores

Leadership

WeCode KC - Web Dev and Programming Volunteer

February 2024 - Present

- Provided IT support and web development guidance to 20+ high school students learning HTML, CSS, and JavaScript
- Designed and reviewed student web projects for responsiveness and user experience
- Created a welcoming space that encouraged creativity through web design